

LUCKY TWELVE

BIRTH-YEAR ANIMAL CHARMS

12 Chinese Zodiac Amigurumi Keychain Patterns



DIGITAL PATTERN

US crochet terms | Intermediate | Sport-weight or fine DK cotton | 2.25 mm hook
Includes the complete written pattern and a 47-step visual guidance section.

This document contains digital crochet instructions. No physical item is included.

Pattern Information

Read before beginning

IMPORTANT VISUAL-GUIDE NOTICE

The step images are visual placement and shaping guides. The written stitch counts, component instructions and assembly positions in this pattern are the technical authority. Some concept-style images may simplify hidden construction details.

Product Overview

Field	Details
Product category	Mini amigurumi keychain / bag charm collection
Construction	Continuous rounds, row-based details and sewn assembly
Skill level	Intermediate
Terminology	US crochet terms
Finished size	Approximately 7.5-8.5 cm tall; rabbit and dragon up to 9 cm
Total hanging length	Approximately 10.5-12 cm including clasp
Pattern status	Mathematically and structurally checked; physical sample testing is still recommended before commercial publication

The 12 Animals

- Rat
- Ox
- Tiger
- Rabbit
- Dragon
- Snake
- Horse
- Goat
- Monkey
- Rooster
- Dog
- Pig

Safety

- Safety eyes are not suitable for children under three. Use securely embroidered eyes for children's products.
- These charms are decorative accessories, not infant toys.
- Test every keychain anchor and clasp before use.

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LAYOUT

Written instructions use compact portrait pages. The visual-guidance section uses A4 landscape pages with two evenly aligned step images per page.

1. Materials, Colour Palette and Abbreviations

Yarn

Sport-weight or fine DK cotton yarn, approximately 150-180 metres per 50 g.

- 8-12 g of the main colour per animal
- 1-4 g of each contrast colour
- Approximately 120-160 g for the full collection; confirm during physical sample testing

Tools and Additional Materials

- 2.25 mm crochet hook
- 24 x 5 mm black safety eyes, or black embroidery thread
- Polyester toy stuffing
- 12 lobster-clasp keychains, approximately 30-35 mm
- Black, pink and optional red embroidery thread
- Tapestry needle
- Stitch marker
- Pins
- Scissors
- Small pliers, optional
- Strong polyester sewing thread or beading cord, optional but recommended for reinforcement

Suggested Colour Palette

Animal	Colours
Rat	Slate grey, dusty pink, black
Ox	Chocolate brown, cream, ochre, dark brown
Tiger	Golden yellow, cream, black
Rabbit	Ivory, pale pink, black
Dragon	Deep teal, light teal, mustard gold, dark teal
Snake	Sage green, dark olive, optional red
Horse	Muted plum, dusty mauve, dark plum
Goat	Warm cream, taupe, light taupe
Monkey	Chestnut brown, beige
Rooster	Ivory, red, golden yellow, warm orange
Dog	Caramel tan, chocolate brown, cream, dark brown
Pig	Blush pink, darker pink, pale pink

Abbreviations

Abbreviation	Meaning
BLO	Back loop only
ch	Chain
dc	Double crochet
dec	Invisible single crochet decrease
FO	Fasten off
hdc	Half double crochet
inc	Two single crochets in one stitch
MR	Magic ring
R / Rnd	Round
sc	Single crochet
sc2tog	Single crochet two stitches together
sl st	Slip stitch
st / sts	Stitch / stitches
tr	Treble crochet
[]	Stitch count
() x n	Repeat instructions inside parentheses

2. Construction Notes, Gauge and Alignment

Gauge

Eight sc stitches x eight sc rows should measure approximately 2.5 cm when worked with firm amigurumi tension. Exact gauge is less important than producing dense fabric through which stuffing cannot be seen.

Construction Notes

- Work three-dimensional components in continuous spirals unless instructed otherwise.
- Do not join rounds unless specifically instructed.
- Mark the first stitch of every round.
- Use an invisible decrease.
- Keep tension firm and consistent.
- Do not overstuff ears, horns, tails, wings or limbs.
- Heads are worked from the crown downward; bodies are worked from the base upward.
- Head and body openings each finish with 12 stitches.
- Sewn assembly is required. This is not a no-sew pattern.

Alignment Reference

- Front centre: midpoint between the two eye posts.
- Back centre: point directly opposite the front centre.
- Side centres: points halfway between front and back.
- Crown centre: centre of Head R1.
- Use these reference points instead of relying on the spiral seam.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The collection should share a consistent visual system: rounded heads, short oval bodies, tiny limbs and antique-brass-style clasps. Species recognition should come from ears, muzzles, horns, tails, wings, colour blocking and embroidery.

3. Shared Components

Standard Round Head

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2	Inc in each st around. [12]
R3	(Sc in next st, inc in next st) x 6. [18]
R4	(Sc in next 2 sts, inc in next st) x 6. [24]
R5-R8	Sc in each st around. [24 each]
Pause	Install the animal's eyes and reinforced keychain anchor before continuing.
R9	(Sc in next 2 sts, dec) x 6. [18]
R10	(Sc in next st, dec) x 6. [12]
Finish	Stuff firmly. Keep the crown rounded and the opening centred beneath the face. FO; leave the 12-stitch opening unclosed.

VISUAL MILESTONE

The head should be almost spherical and slightly wider than tall.

Standard Body

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2	Inc in each st around. [12]
R3	(Sc in next st, inc in next st) x 6. [18]
R4-R6	Sc in each st around. [18 each]
R7	(Sc in next st, dec) x 6. [12]
R8	Sc in each st around. [12]
Finish	Stuff the lower body firmly and the neck moderately. FO, leaving a 35 cm joining tail.

VISUAL MILESTONE

The body should be a short oval capsule and remain narrower than the head.

Standard Arm - make two unless wings are specified

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2-R4	Sc in each st around. [6 each]
Finish	Do not stuff. Flatten and work 3 sc through both layers. [3] FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Standard Leg - make two

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2-R3	Sc in each st around. [6 each]
Finish	Add a very small amount of stuffing to the rounded end. Flatten and work 3 sc through both layers. [3] FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Small Round Ear

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2	Inc in each st around. [12]
Finish	Sl st in next st. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Inner Ear Circle

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
Finish	Sl st in first sc. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Small Pointed Ear

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	4 sc in MR. [4]
R2	(Sc in next st, inc in next st) x 2. [6]
R3	Sc in each st around. [6]
Finish	Do not stuff. Flatten and work 3 sc through both layers. [3] FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Flat Leaf Ear

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 5.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch: sc, hdc, dc, 3 dc in final ch; continue along unused underside: dc, hdc, sc. [9]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Small Oval Muzzle

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 5.
R1	Beginning in second ch: sc, sc in next 2 ch, 3 sc in final ch; continue along underside: sc in next 2 loops, 2 sc in final loop. [10]
Finish	Sl st in first sc. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Large Oval Muzzle

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	Complete the Small Oval Muzzle through R1. [10]
R2	Inc in next st, sc in next 2 sts, inc in each of next 3 sts, sc in next 2 sts, inc in each of final 2 sts. [16]
Finish	Sl st in next st. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Round Muzzle

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2	Inc in each st around. [12]
Finish	Sl st in next st. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Short Horn

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 5.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch: sl st, sc, hdc, dc. [4]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Long Curved Horn

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 7.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch: sl st, sc in next 2 ch, hdc in next 2 ch, dc in final ch. [6]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Tiny Tail Ball

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2	Inc in each st around. [12]
R3	Sc in each st around. [12]
R4	Dec around. [6]
Finish	Stuff lightly. FO and close the opening.

Triangular Wing

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 5.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch, sc in each ch across. [4]
Row 2	Ch 1, turn. Sc2tog, sc in next 2 sts. [3]
Row 3	Ch 1, turn. Sc2tog, sc in final st. [2]
Row 4	Ch 1, turn. Sc2tog. [1]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Small Dorsal Spike

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 4.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch: sl st, sc, hdc. [3]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

4. Reinforced Keychain Anchor

20. Hold two strands of matching yarn together.
21. Insert the hook through the lower eye of the lobster clasp.
22. Pull a yarn loop through the hardware.
23. Ch 8.
24. Sl st in the first ch to form an eight-chain loop around the clasp.
25. FO, leaving both yarn ends at least 25 cm long.
26. Thread both ends through the centre of Head R1 from outside to inside.
27. Pull until the chain loop rests against the crown.
28. Pass one tail through stitches on one side of Head R2 three times.
29. Pass the other tail through the opposite side three times.
30. Tie two firm square knots.
31. Leave approximately 2 cm of each tail inside the head and surround the knot with stuffing.

DURABILITY

Reinforce the anchor with strong polyester sewing thread for frequently used charms. The clasp must not pull against ears, horns or decorative pieces.

5. General Standing-Animal Assembly

Join the Head and Body

32. Place the 12-stitch body opening against the 12-stitch head opening.
33. Align front centre, back centre and both side centres.
34. Pair one head stitch with one body stitch at all 12 positions.
35. Whipstitch through corresponding stitches.
36. Before closing the final two positions, add stuffing if needed.
37. Close the seam, knot securely and bury the tail.

Attach the Arms

- Position between Body R5 and R6.
- Centre one arm at each side-centre point.
- Sew the entire three-stitch flattened edge.
- Keep both arms at the same height.

Attach the Legs

- Position between Body R2 and R3.
- Leave approximately two visible body stitches between the inner leg edges.
- Angle the feet slightly forward.
- Sew the entire three-stitch flattened edge.

PLACEMENT GUIDE

Pin paired components first. Check from the front, side and top before permanently tightening the sewing stitches.

6. Rat

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in slate grey
- Two Small Round Ears in grey
- Two Inner Ear Circles in dusty pink
- One tail and one reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	With dusty pink, ch 18.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch, sl st in each ch across. [17]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

38. Sew one pink inner circle to each grey ear.
39. Sew ears over Head R3-R5, leaving approximately seven stitches between the inner edges.
40. Embroider a pink nose between Head R7 and R8.
41. Add a short black mouth line and two short whiskers on each cheek.
42. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
43. Sew tail at back centre between Body R4 and R5; curve and tack the tip lightly.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The ears should be the widest facial feature. Keep the muzzle narrow so the animal reads as a zodiac rat rather than a bear.

7. Ox

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in chocolate brown
- Two Flat Leaf Ears in brown
- Two Short Horns in ochre
- One Large Oval Muzzle in cream
- One tail and one reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	With chocolate brown, ch 9.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch, sl st in each ch across. [8]
Tassel	Attach three 4 cm dark-brown strands to the tip and trim to 1.5 cm.

Assembly

44. Sew the cream muzzle over Head R7-R9.
45. Embroider two nostrils three stitches apart and add a short inverted-Y mouth.
46. Sew horns over Head R2-R3, approximately five stitches apart.
47. Sew ears outside the horns over Head R4-R5 and angle them outward.
48. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
49. Sew tail at back centre between Body R5 and R6.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The wide cream muzzle and small horns are the key recognition features. Horns should remain visible above the ears.

8. Tiger

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in golden yellow
- Two Small Round Ears in yellow
- Two cream Inner Ear Circles
- One cream Round Muzzle
- One tail and one reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Striped Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	With black, 5 sc in MR. [5]
R2	Sc around. [5]
Change colour	Change to golden yellow.
R3-R8	Sc in each st around. [5 each]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

50. Sew cream centres to the ears and attach the ears over Head R3-R5.
51. Sew the muzzle over Head R7-R9.
52. Embroider a black triangular nose and inverted-Y mouth.
53. Add one central forehead stripe, two diagonal stripes on each side and two short cheek stripes on each side.
54. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
55. Add two black body stripes on each side over Body R4-R6.
56. Sew tail at back centre between Body R4 and R5; curve the black tip upward and tack lightly.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

Keep the tiger predominantly golden yellow. Use short, neat black lines so the face remains soft and readable.

9. Rabbit

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in ivory
- Two Long Ears
- One Tiny Tail Ball in ivory
- One reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Long Ear - make two

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	5 sc in MR. [5]
R2	Inc in each st around. [10]
R3-R6	Sc in each st around. [10 each]
R7	(Sc in next 3 sts, dec) x 2. [8]
R8	Sc in each st around. [8]
Finish	Do not stuff. Flatten and work 4 sc through both layers. [4] FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

- 57. Embroider a pale-pink inner-ear line from Ear R2 to R7.
- 58. Sew ears over Head R2-R4, leaving approximately four stitches between the bases.
- 59. Angle one ear slightly outward.
- 60. Embroider a pink triangular nose between Head R7 and R8 and add a short mouth.
- 61. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
- 62. Sew the tail ball at back centre over Body R3-R5.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The ears should account for roughly one-third of the total height. Keep them soft and unstuffed.

10. Dragon

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in deep teal
- Two Small Pointed Ears
- Two mustard Long Curved Horns
- One light-teal Round Muzzle
- Two Triangular Wings
- Four mustard Small Dorsal Spikes
- One tail and one reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Dragon Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2-R7	Sc around. [6 each]
R8	(Sc in next st, dec) x 2. [4]
R9-R10	Sc around. [4 each]
Finish	Lightly stuff R1-R5 only. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

- 63. Sew the muzzle over Head R7-R9 and embroider two nostrils.
- 64. Sew horns over Head R2-R3, five stitches apart.
- 65. Sew pointed ears outside the horns over Head R3-R5.
- 66. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
- 67. Sew wings to Body R4-R6 with the four-stitch edge against the body; angle points upward.
- 68. Sew tail at back centre between Body R3 and R5; curve and tack it to one side.
- 69. Sew one spike at the rear of Head R3 and three more down the back from Head R5 to Body R5.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The compact dragon needs all three signature groups: horns, wings and dorsal spikes.

11. Snake

The snake is worked as one continuous head-and-body component in sage green.

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2	Inc around. [12]
R3	(Sc, inc) x 6. [18]
R4-R6	Sc around. [18 each]
Pause	Place eyes between R4 and R5 with four visible stitches between posts. Install the keychain anchor through the centre of R1.
R7	(Sc, dec) x 6. [12]
R8	(Sc in next 2 sts, dec) x 3. [9]
Stuff	Stuff the head firmly.
R9-R30	Sc in each st around. [9 each]
Stuff	Stuff gradually, reducing stuffing towards the tail.
R31	(Sc, dec) x 3. [6]
R32-R34	Sc around. [6 each]
R35	Dec x 3. [3]
Finish	FO and close.

Finishing and Coil Formation

- 70. Embroider two nostrils over R6 and add a small curved mouth.
- 71. Curve R9-R20 downward and clockwise.
- 72. Coil R21-R34 beneath the head.
- 73. Tack R22 to approximately R13.
- 74. Tack R30 to approximately R19.
- 75. Leave the final 2 cm of tail visible.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The coil should support the head without compressing it. From the front, the body should form a clear curved S shape.

12. Horse

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in muted plum
- Two Flat Leaf Ears
- One Large Oval Muzzle in dusty mauve
- One dark-plum mane
- One tail and one reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Mane

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	With dark plum, ch 10.
Motifs	Beginning in second ch, repeat across all nine chains: sl st in next foundation chain, ch 3, sl st again into the same chain.
Finish	Nine mane loops are formed. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 10.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch, sl st in each ch across. [9]
Fringe	Attach five 7 cm strands to the free end and trim to 2.5 cm.

Assembly

76. Sew the muzzle over Head R7-R9 and embroider nostrils plus a short mouth.
77. Sew ears over Head R3-R4, approximately five stitches apart.
78. Sew mane from Head R2 down the back to Head R9.
79. Join head and body; continue the lower mane approximately two body rounds.
80. Attach arms and legs.
81. Sew tail at back centre between Body R4 and R5.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

Both the long muzzle and visible mane are required; without them the figure may resemble a goat or deer.

13. Goat

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in warm cream
- Two Flat Leaf Ears
- Two taupe Long Curved Horns
- One Small Oval Muzzle in light taupe
- One beard
- One short tail
- One reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT
Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Beard

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	Ch 5.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch: sl st, sc, hdc, dc. [4]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2-R3	Sc around. [6 each]
Finish	Flatten and work 3 sc through both layers. [3] FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

82.

Sew muzzle over Head R7-R9 and embroider two nostrils.
83.

Sew beard beneath the muzzle.
84.

Sew horns over Head R2-R4, four stitches apart; curve the tips backward.
85.

Sew ears outside the horns over Head R4-R5.
86.

Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
87.

Sew tail at back centre between Body R5 and R6.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT
The beard must remain clearly visible. Horns should curve backwards rather than outward like ox horns.

14. Monkey

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in chestnut brown
- Two Small Round Ears
- Two beige Inner Ear Circles
- One beige Large Oval Muzzle
- One long tail
- One reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT
Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Long Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2-R12	Sc around. [6 each]
R13	(Sc, dec) x 2. [4]
R14-R15	Sc around. [4 each]
Finish	Do not stuff beyond R6. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

88. Sew beige circles to the ears and attach ears over Head R5-R7, almost level with the eyes.
89. Sew muzzle over Head R7-R9.
90. Embroider nostrils and a smile.
91. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
92. Sew tail at back centre between Body R4 and R5.
93. Curve into a loose C shape and tack Tail R9 to the body.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT
Round side ears and a visible curled tail are the main monkey identifiers.

15. Rooster

Make

- Standard Head and Body in ivory
- Two Standard Legs in golden yellow
- Two Triangular Wings in ivory
- Three red comb circles
- Two red wattle circles
- One golden-yellow beak
- Three tail feathers
- One reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT
Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Comb Circle - make three

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Wattle Circle - make two

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	5 sc in MR. [5]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Beak

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	4 sc in MR. [4]
R2	Sc around. [4]
Finish	Flatten and FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Tail Feather - make three

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
Colours	Make one each in golden yellow, ivory and warm orange.
Foundatio n	Ch 8.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch: sl st, sc, hdc, dc in next 2 ch, tr in final 2 ch. [7]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

94. Sew beak over Head R7.
95. Sew wattles beneath the beak.
96. Sew three comb circles across Head R1-R3; centre circle slightly higher.
97. Join head and body.
98. Sew wings over Body R4-R6.
99. Attach legs between Body R2 and R3 and embroider three toe lines beneath each leg.
100. Layer tail feathers at back centre over Body R4-R6 and fan the tips outward.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The red comb, yellow beak and layered tail must all be visible so the rooster does not read as a generic bird.

16. Dog

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in caramel
- Two chocolate-brown Floppy Ears
- One cream Round Muzzle
- One tail
- One reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Floppy Ear - make two

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
Foundatio n	Ch 6.
R1	Beginning in second ch: sc in next 4 ch, 3 sc in final ch; continue along unused underside, sc in next 3 loops, 2 sc in final loop. [12]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Tail

Round/R ow	Instructions and stitch count
R1	6 sc in MR. [6]
R2-R6	Sc around. [6 each]
R7	(Sc, dec) x 2. [4]
R8	Sc around. [4]
Finish	Lightly stuff the base only. FO, leaving a sewing tail.

Assembly

101. Sew muzzle over Head R7-R9.
102. Embroider a dark-brown triangular nose and inverted-Y mouth.
103. Sew ears over Head R4-R6, attaching only the upper third so the lower sections hang freely.
104. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
105. Sew tail at back centre over Body R4-R5.
106. Curve tail upward and tack lightly.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The ears should hang below eye level. Short or upright ears may make the animal resemble a bear or fox.

17. Pig

Make

- Standard Head, Body, two Arms and two Legs in blush pink
- Two Small Pointed Ears
- One darker-pink Round Muzzle
- One spiral tail
- One reinforced keychain anchor

EYE PLACEMENT

Place 5 mm eyes between Head R6 and R7 with five visible stitches between the posts.

Spiral Tail

Round/Row	Instructions and stitch count
Foundation	With darker pink, ch 13.
Row 1	Beginning in second ch, work 2 sc in each ch across. [24]
Finish	FO, leaving a sewing tail. The piece should curl naturally.

Assembly

- 107. Sew snout over Head R7-R9.
- 108. Embroider two nostrils and add a small curved mouth.
- 109. Sew ears over Head R3-R5 and angle the tips outward.
- 110. Embroider a pale-pink line inside each ear.
- 111. Join head and body. Attach arms and legs.
- 112. Sew spiral tail at back centre between Body R4 and R5. Secure only the base so the curl remains visible.

VISUAL CHECKPOINT

The darker round snout and curled tail are essential. Keep the ears small enough that the pig does not resemble the rabbit.

18. Final Finishing and Care

Final Finishing

113. Check that paired components are level.
114. Roll each animal gently between the palms to distribute stuffing.
115. Shape the head into a slightly wide sphere.
116. Keep the body shorter and narrower than the head.
117. Secure all sewing knots.
118. Bury each yarn tail through the stuffing and bring it out at a distant point.
119. Pull the tail gently, trim close and allow the cut end to retract.
120. Trim visible fibres without cutting crochet stitches.
121. Inspect embroidered details for loose loops.
122. Pull each clasp firmly ten times while supporting the head.
123. Reinforce any moving anchor with polyester thread.
124. Do not steam-block the finished animals.

Care Instructions

- Surface clean with a slightly damp cloth.
- Do not machine wash charms with metal hardware.
- Do not soak plated clasps.
- Reshape while damp and dry flat away from direct heat.
- Inspect the clasp and anchor regularly.

Pre-Publication Checklist

- Crochet all 12 physical samples using the listed yarn and hook.
- Record final dimensions, weights and actual yarn quantities.
- Have the pattern independently tested by at least one intermediate crocheter.
- Replace concept imagery with real sample photography for the main Etsy listing images.
- Do not advertise this pattern as no-sew.

TECHNICAL AUTHORITY

The written pattern above is the source of truth. The following images provide visual guidance for sequence, placement, proportion and finishing.

STEP 1 — Gather Materials & Preview the Bundle

Lucky Twelve Birth-Year Animal Charms

- Use sport-weight cotton yarn
- Hook: 2.25 mm
- Prepare stuffing, 5 mm eyes, needle & clasps
- Keep tension firm for small amigurumi
- This tutorial begins with the shared base pieces

Goal: create 12 mini zodiac animal keychains with one core body system.



Step 1 - Gather Materials

Visual placement guide; written stitch counts are authoritative.

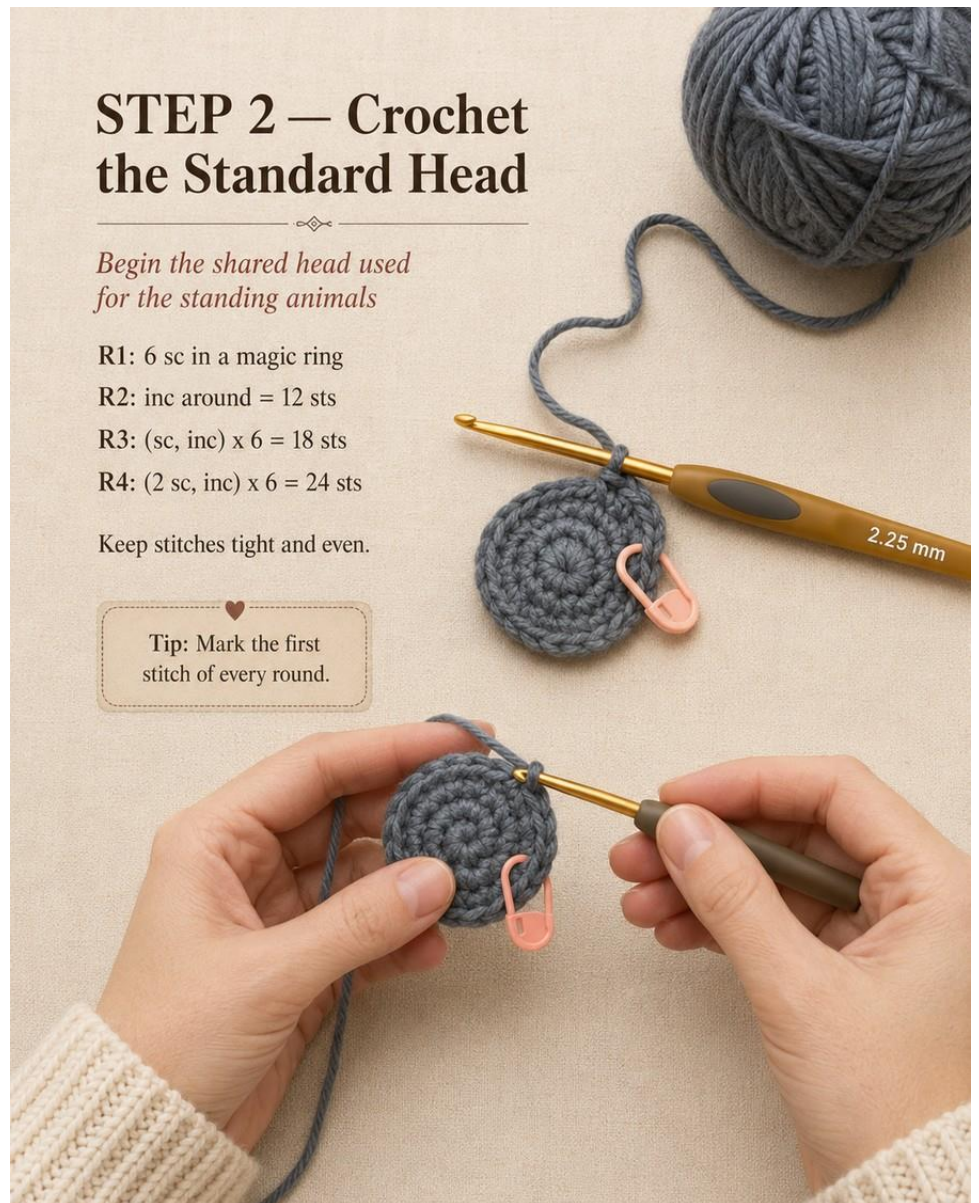
STEP 2 — Crochet the Standard Head

Begin the shared head used for the standing animals

- R1: 6 sc in a magic ring
 R2: inc around = 12 sts
 R3: (sc, inc) x 6 = 18 sts
 R4: (2 sc, inc) x 6 = 24 sts

Keep stitches tight and even.

Tip: Mark the first stitch of every round.



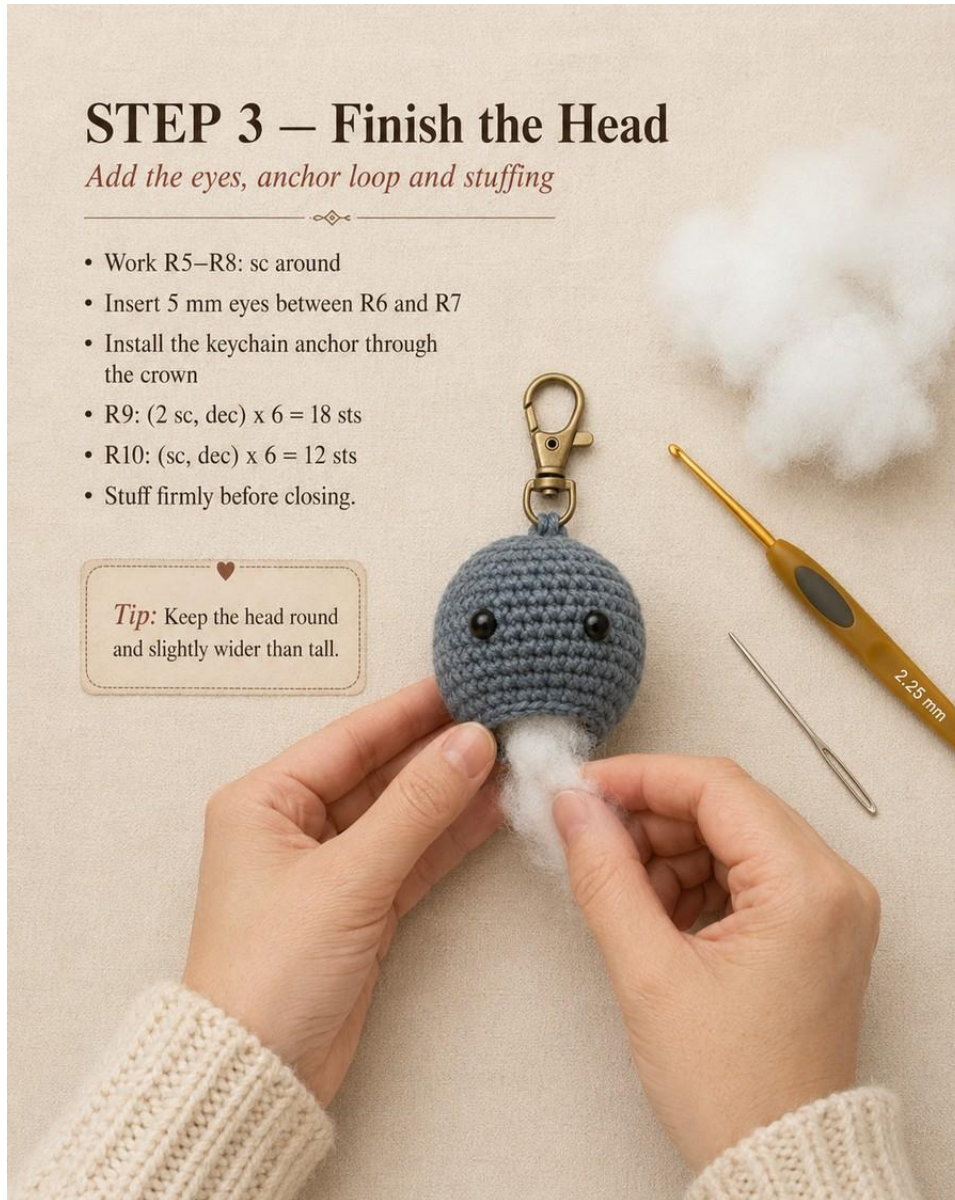
Step 2 - Crochet the Standard Head

STEP 3 — Finish the Head

Add the eyes, anchor loop and stuffing

- Work R5–R8: sc around
- Insert 5 mm eyes between R6 and R7
- Install the keychain anchor through the crown
- R9: (2 sc, dec) x 6 = 18 sts
- R10: (sc, dec) x 6 = 12 sts
- Stuff firmly before closing.

Tip: Keep the head round and slightly wider than tall.



Step 3 - Finish the Head

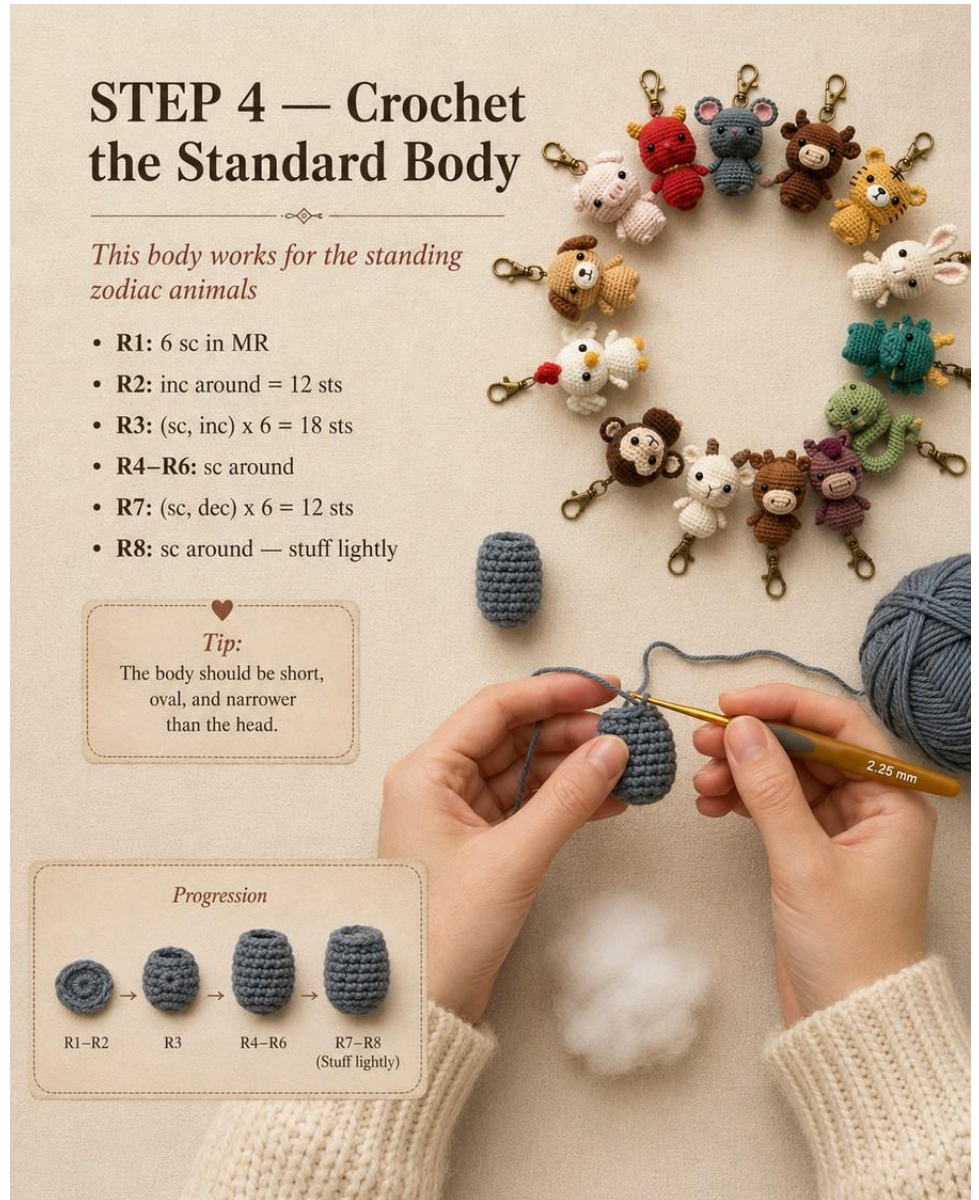
STEP 4 — Crochet the Standard Body

This body works for the standing zodiac animals

- R1: 6 sc in MR
- R2: inc around = 12 sts
- R3: (sc, inc) x 6 = 18 sts
- R4–R6: sc around
- R7: (sc, dec) x 6 = 12 sts
- R8: sc around — stuff lightly

Tip: The body should be short, oval, and narrower than the head.

Progression



Step 4 - Crochet the Standard Body

STEP 5 — Make the Arms & Legs

Crochet 2 arms and 2 legs for the base doll

- Arms: R1–R4 = 6 sts around
- Do not stuff the arms
- Legs: R1–R3 = 6 sts around
- Add a tiny bit of stuffing to the legs
- Flatten each opening and close with 3 sc

TIP:

Small parts look best with firm, even tension.



Step 5 - Make the Arms and Legs

STEP 6 — Assemble the Base Doll

Join the head and body, then add the limbs

- Match the 12 head stitches to the 12 body stitches
- Whipstitch the openings together
- Attach arms between body rounds 5 and 6
- Attach legs between body rounds 2 and 3
- Keep the face centered and the limbs even

Tip:

Pin the pieces first to check symmetry.



Step 6 - Assemble the Base Doll

STEP 7 — Crochet the Rat Details

Prepare the ears and tail

- Make 2 grey round ears
- Make 2 pink inner-ear circles
- Sew one pink circle to each ear
- Crochet a pink tail: ch 18, sl st back
- Keep the ears soft and unstuffed

♥
Tip:

Small contrast pieces
help the face read clearly.



Step 7 - Crochet the Rat Details

STEP 8 — Build the Rat Face

Attach the ears and embroider the expression

- Sew the ears across the top of the head
- Leave about 7 stitches between the inner ear edges
- Embroider a pink nose between R7 and R8
- Add a short black mouth line
- Stitch 2 whiskers on each cheek

♥
TIP:

Check the face from the front
before tightening the stitches.



Step 8 - Build the Rat Face

STEP 9 — Finish the Rat Charm

Attach the tail and do the final shaping

- Sew the tail to the center back of the body
- Curve the tail and tack the tip lightly
- Check the head, body and limb alignment
- Adjust the stuffing and shape the face
- Your first zodiac charm is complete

♥
A gentle final squeeze helps round out the head and body.



Step 9 - Finish the Rat Charm

STEP 10 — Start the Ox Charm

Prepare the horns, ears, muzzle and tail

- Make 2 short ochre horns
- Make 2 brown leaf ears
- Crochet 1 cream oval muzzle
- Add a brown tail with a small tassel
- Pin the muzzle before sewing the features

♥
Tip:
The horns and large muzzle are the key ox details.



Step 10 - Start the Ox Charm

STEP 11 — Finish the Ox Face

Attach the muzzle, horns and ears

- Pin the large cream muzzle to the center of the head
- Embroider 2 nostrils and a short mouth
- Sew 2 ochre horns across the top
- Add the brown leaf ears just outside the horns
- Check symmetry before tightening

Tip:

The wide muzzle and small horns give the ox its character.



Step 11 - Finish the Ox Face

STEP 12 — Finish the Ox Charm

Add the tail and complete the assembly

- Join the head and body with matching stitches
- Attach arms at body rounds 5 and 6
- Attach legs at body rounds 2 and 3
- Sew the tassel tail to the center back
- Shape the body and check the clasp

Tip:

Keep the ox sturdy, compact and well balanced.



Step 12 - Finish the Ox Charm

STEP 13 — Start the Tiger Charm

Prepare the ears, muzzle and striped tail

- Make 2 yellow round ears
- Sew 2 cream inner-ear circles
- Crochet 1 cream round muzzle
- Make the tail with a black tip and yellow body
- Gather black yarn for the stripes

Tip:

High-contrast stripes make the tiger easy to recognize.



Step 13 - Start the Tiger Charm

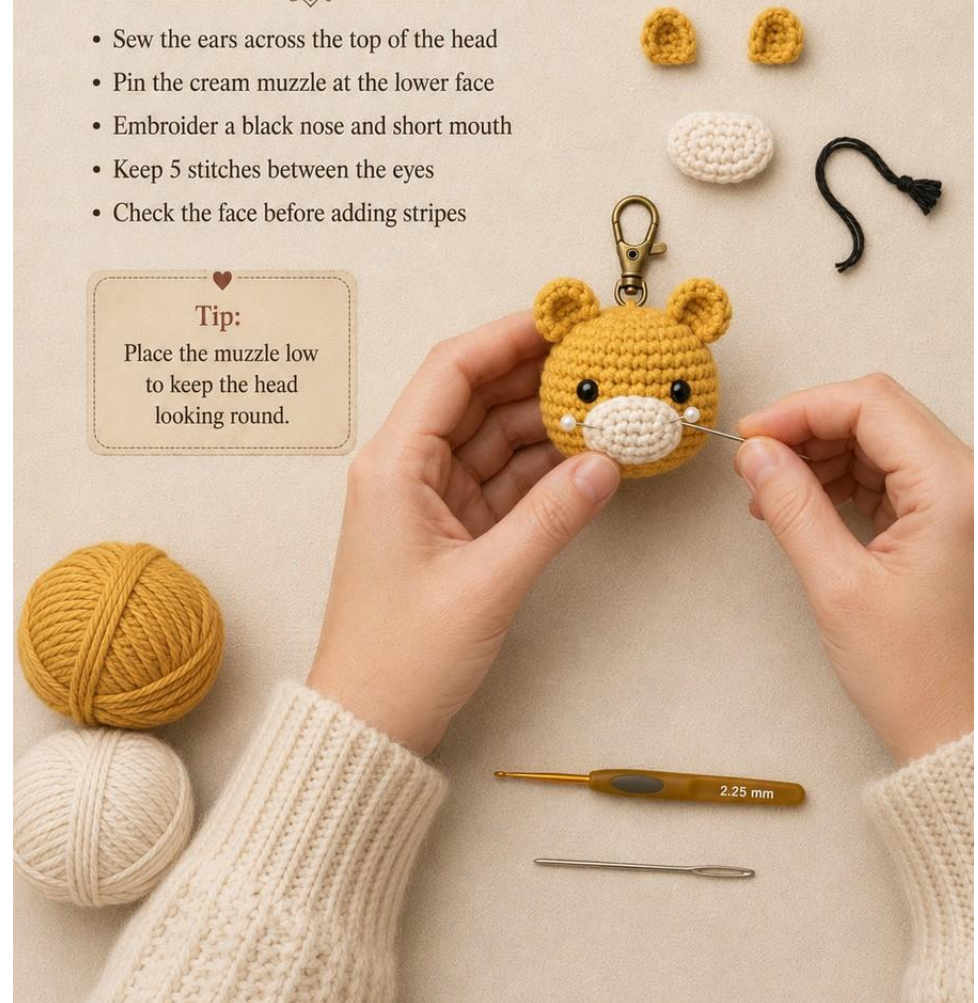
STEP 14 — Build the Tiger Face

Attach the ears and muzzle first

- Sew the ears across the top of the head
- Pin the cream muzzle at the lower face
- Embroider a black nose and short mouth
- Keep 5 stitches between the eyes
- Check the face before adding stripes

Tip:

Place the muzzle low to keep the head looking round.



Step 14 - Build the Tiger Face

STEP 15 — Add the Tiger Stripes & Tail

Embroider the markings and attach the tail

- Stitch 1 forehead stripe down the center
- Add 2 side stripes on each side of the head
- Add 2 short cheek stripes
- Sew the tail to the center back of the body
- Curve the black tip upward

Tip:

Use short, neat lines so the tiger stays cute, not harsh.



Step 15 - Add the Tiger Stripes and Tail

STEP 16 — Finish the Tiger Charm

Join the body and complete the details

- Join the head and body
- Attach the arms and legs
- Add 2 small body stripes on each side
- Check the tail, muzzle and face placement
- Your tiger charm is complete

Tip:

The head should stay larger than the body for a cute look.



Step 16 - Finish the Tiger Charm

STEP 17 — Start the Rabbit Charm

Prepare the long ears and tail

- Crochet 2 long ivory ears
- Embroider a pale pink line inside each ear
- Make 1 tiny round tail ball
- Keep the ears soft and unstuffed
- Pin the ears before sewing

Tip:

Tall ears are the rabbit's signature feature.



Step 17 - Start the Rabbit Charm

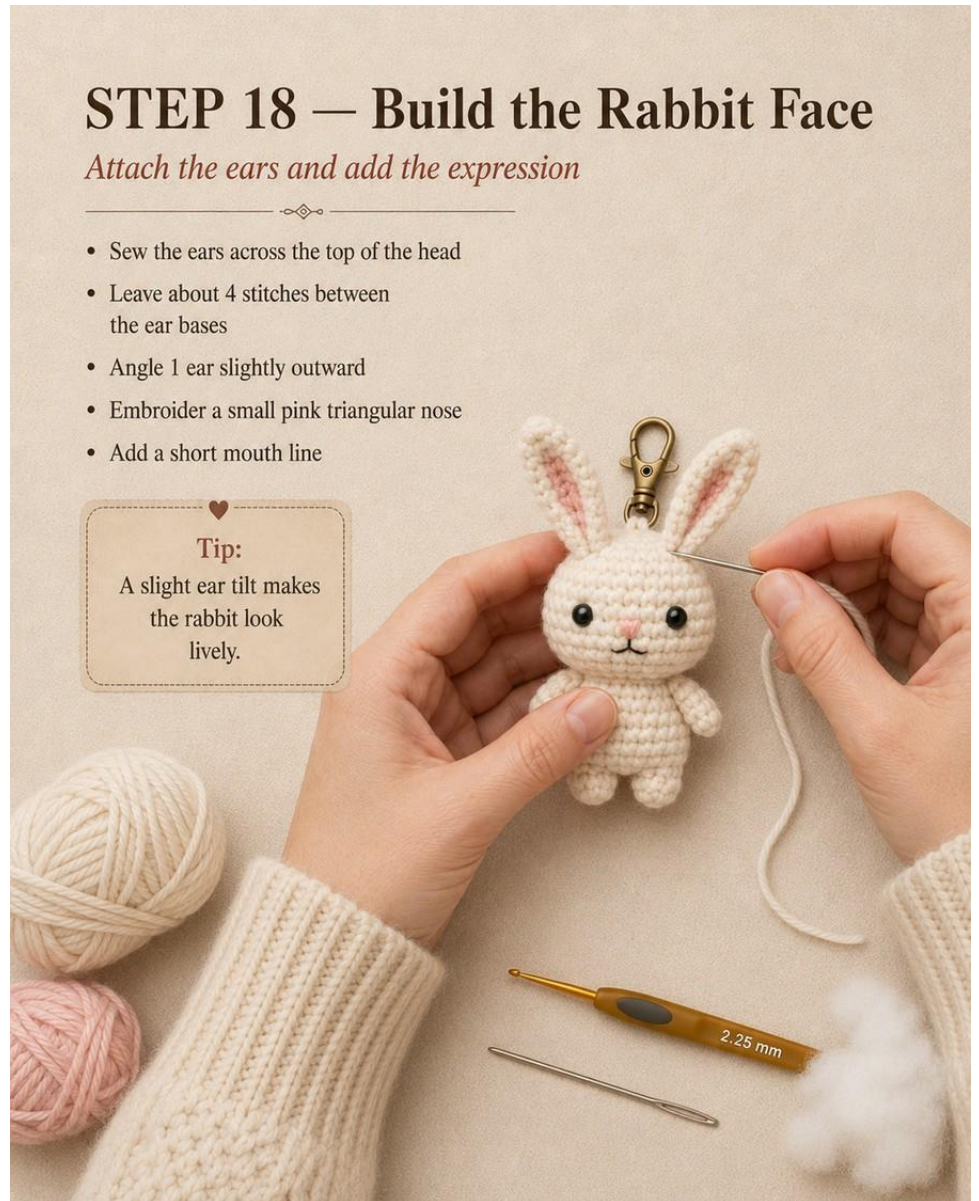
STEP 18 — Build the Rabbit Face

Attach the ears and add the expression

- Sew the ears across the top of the head
- Leave about 4 stitches between the ear bases
- Angle 1 ear slightly outward
- Embroider a small pink triangular nose
- Add a short mouth line

Tip:

A slight ear tilt makes the rabbit look lively.



Step 18 - Build the Rabbit Face

STEP 19 — Assemble the Rabbit Charm

Add the body, limbs and tail

- Join the head and body
- Attach arms at body rounds 5 and 6
- Attach legs at body rounds 2 and 3
- Sew the tail ball to the center back
- Adjust the stuffing and shape

Tip:

Keep the rabbit slim,
upright and neatly
balanced.



Step 19 - Assemble the Rabbit Charm

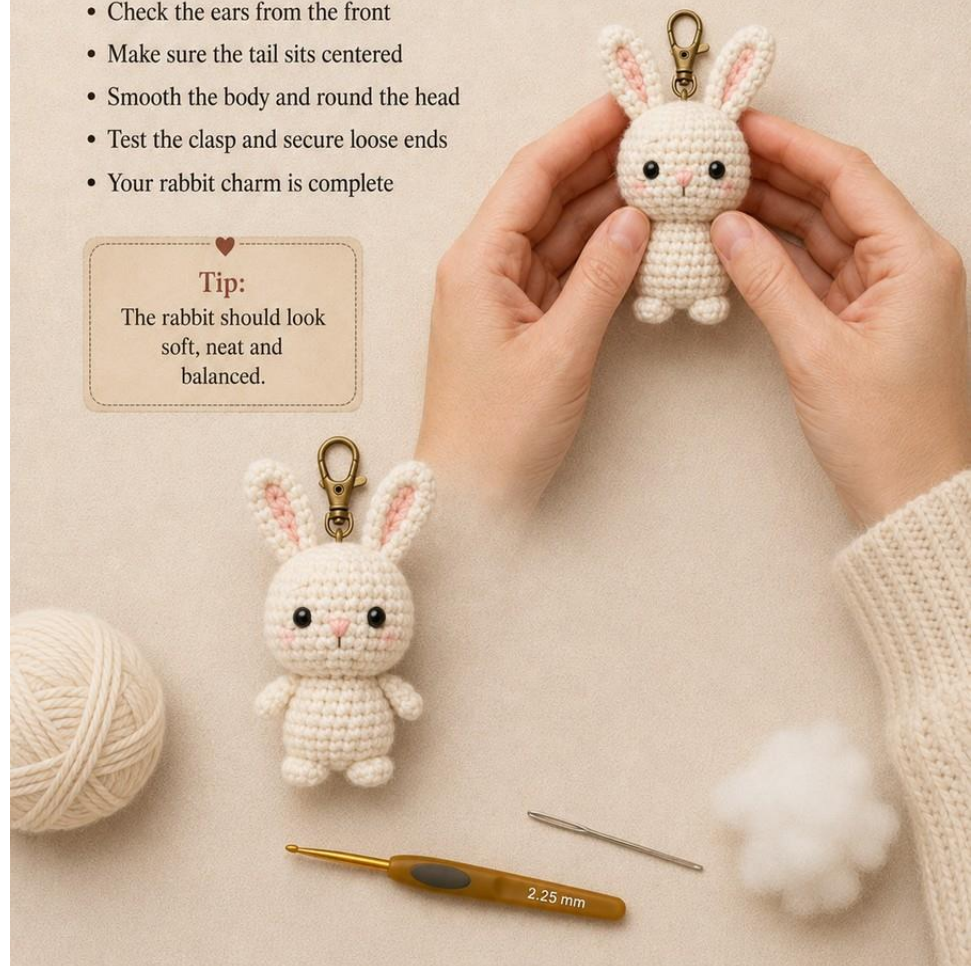
STEP 20 — Finish the Rabbit Charm

Final shaping and ready-to-display charm

- Check the ears from the front
- Make sure the tail sits centered
- Smooth the body and round the head
- Test the clasp and secure loose ends
- Your rabbit charm is complete

Tip:

The rabbit should look
soft, neat and
balanced.



Step 20 - Finish the Rabbit Charm

STEP 21 — Start the Dragon Charm

Prepare the ears, horns, muzzle and tail

- Make 2 teal pointed ears
- Crochet 2 mustard curved horns
- Make 1 light-teal round muzzle
- Crochet 1 tapered tail and stuff only the base
- Prepare 2 wings and 4 dorsal spikes

Tip:

The horns, wings and back spikes make the dragon instantly recognizable.



Step 21 - Start the Dragon Charm

STEP 22 — Build the Dragon Face

Attach the muzzle, horns and ears

- Sew the round muzzle to the lower face
- Embroider 2 nostrils
- Place 2 curved horns across the top
- Add the pointed ears just outside the horns
- Keep the face centered before joining the body

Tip:

Keep the muzzle small so the head stays round.



Step 22 - Build the Dragon Face

STEP 23 — Add the Dragon Wings & Spikes

Sew the wings, spikes and tail

- Join the head and body
- Attach the arms and legs
- Sew 2 wings at body rounds 4 to 6
- Add 1 spike on the head and 3 down the back
- Sew the tail and curve it to one side

Tip:

Angle the wings upward for a playful dragon look.



Step 23 - Add the Dragon Wings and Spikes

STEP 24 — Finish the Dragon Charm

Final shaping and detail check

- Check the horns, ears and wings from the front
- Make sure the spikes run neatly down the back
- Shape the body and tail
- Test the clasp and secure loose ends
- Your dragon charm is complete

Tip:

The dragon should look compact but full of detail.



Step 24 - Finish the Dragon Charm

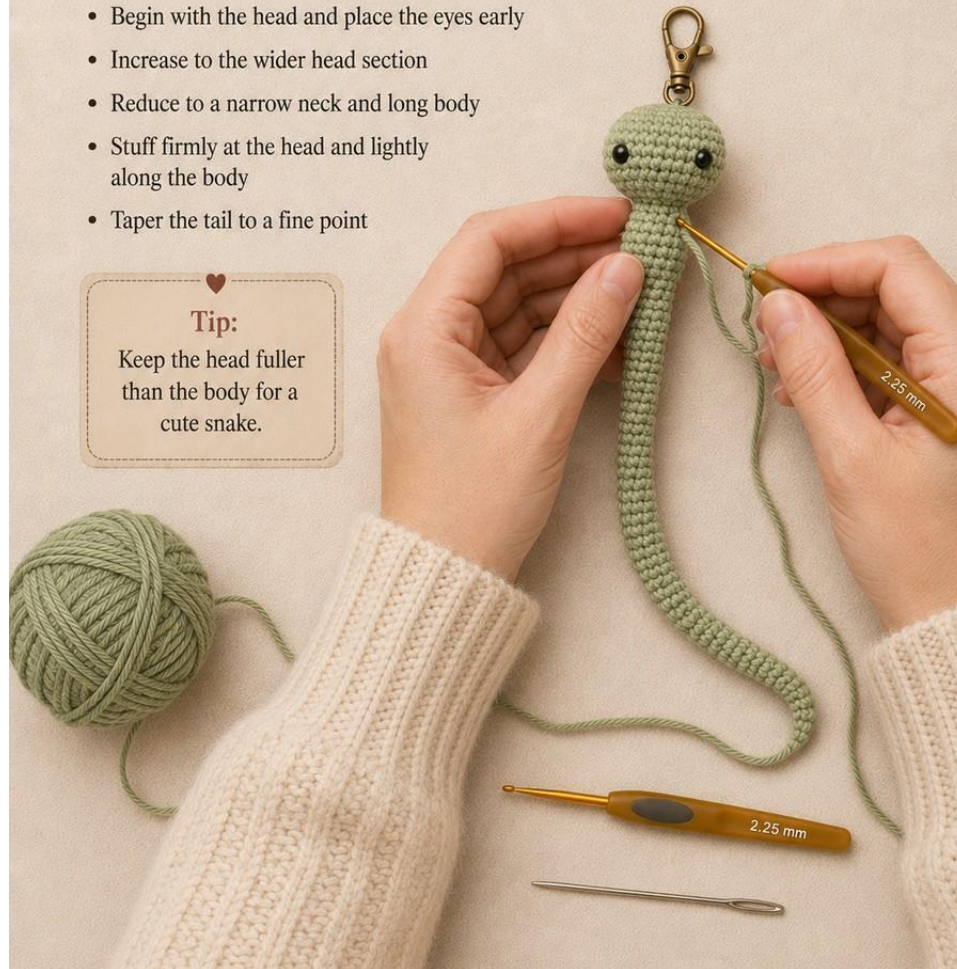
STEP 25 — Start the Snake Charm

Crochet the head, body and tail

- Begin with the head and place the eyes early
- Increase to the wider head section
- Reduce to a narrow neck and long body
- Stuff firmly at the head and lightly along the body
- Taper the tail to a fine point

Tip:

Keep the head fuller than the body for a cute snake.



Step 25 - Start the Snake Charm

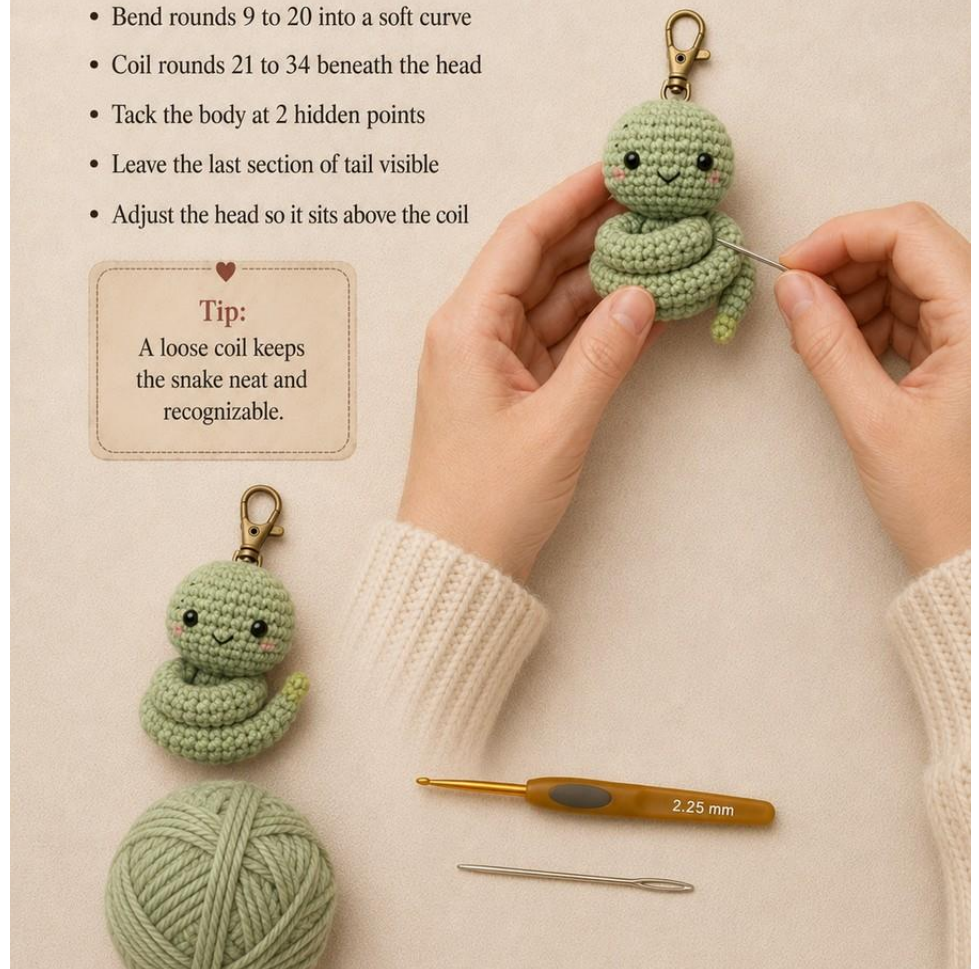
STEP 26 — Shape the Snake Coil

Curve and tack the body into place

- Bend rounds 9 to 20 into a soft curve
- Coil rounds 21 to 34 beneath the head
- Tack the body at 2 hidden points
- Leave the last section of tail visible
- Adjust the head so it sits above the coil

Tip:

A loose coil keeps the snake neat and recognizable.



Step 26 - Shape the Snake Coil

STEP 27 — Finish the Snake Charm

Add the face and final shaping

- Embroider 2 small nostrils
- Add a short curved mouth
- Smooth the body and check the coil
- Test the clasp and secure all tails
- Your snake charm is complete

Tip:

The finished snake should feel compact, tidy and balanced.



Step 27 - Finish the Snake Charm

STEP 28 — Start the Horse Charm

Prepare the ears, muzzle, mane and tail

- Make 2 plum leaf ears
- Crochet 1 dusty-mauve large muzzle
- Chain and sew the dark-plum mane
- Make the tail with fringe at the end
- Gather the body pieces for assembly

Tip:

The mane is the horse's signature detail.



Step 28 - Start the Horse Charm

STEP 29 — Build the Horse Face & Mane

Attach the muzzle, ears and mane

- Sew the large muzzle to the lower face
- Embroider the nostrils and short mouth
- Add 2 ears across the top of the head
- Sew the mane from the crown down the back of the head
- Keep the mane centered before joining the body

♥
Tip:

A centered mane gives the horse a clear silhouette.



Step 29 - Build the Horse Face and Mane

STEP 30 — Finish the Horse Charm

Join the body and complete the tail

- Join the head and body
- Attach the arms and legs
- Continue the mane onto the upper back
- Sew the tail to the center back
- Shape the horse and test the clasp

♥
Tip:

Keep the horse upright and slightly longer in profile.



Step 30 - Finish the Horse Charm

STEP 31 — Start the Goat Charm

Prepare the ears, horns, muzzle, beard and tail

- Make 2 warm-cream leaf ears
- Crochet 2 taupe curved horns
- Make 1 light-taupe oval muzzle
- Crochet 1 small beard and 1 short tail
- Gather the head, body, arms and legs for assembly

Tip:

The beard and backward-curving horns are the goat's signature details.



Step 31 - Start the Goat Charm

STEP 32 — Build the Goat Face

Attach the muzzle, beard, horns and ears

- Sew the oval muzzle to the lower face
- Embroider 2 small nostrils
- Attach the beard beneath the muzzle
- Sew 2 curved horns across the top
- Add the ears outside the horns and keep the face centered

Tip:

Curve the horns backward so the goat is easy to recognize.



Step 32 - Build the Goat Face

STEP 33 — Finish the Goat Charm

Join the body and complete the details

- Join the head and body
- Attach the arms and legs
- Sew the short tail to the center back
- Shape the goat and check the symmetry
- Test the clasp and secure all loose ends

Tip:

Keep the goat compact and soft, with the beard clearly visible.



Step 33 - Finish the Goat Charm

STEP 34 — Start the Monkey Charm

Prepare the ears, muzzle and tail

- Make 2 chestnut round ears
- Sew 2 beige inner ear circles
- Crochet 1 beige oval muzzle
- Make 1 long tail with a gentle curve
- Gather the head, body, arms and legs for assembly

Tip:

The side ears and curved tail make the monkey easy to spot.



Step 34 - Start the Monkey Charm

STEP 35 — Build the Monkey Face

Attach the ears and muzzle

- Sew the beige muzzle to the lower face
- Embroider the nostrils and smile
- Attach the round ears level with the eyes
- Keep the face centered before joining the body
- Prepare the tail for the next step

Tip:

Place the ears low and wide for a classic monkey look.



Step 35 - Build the Monkey Face

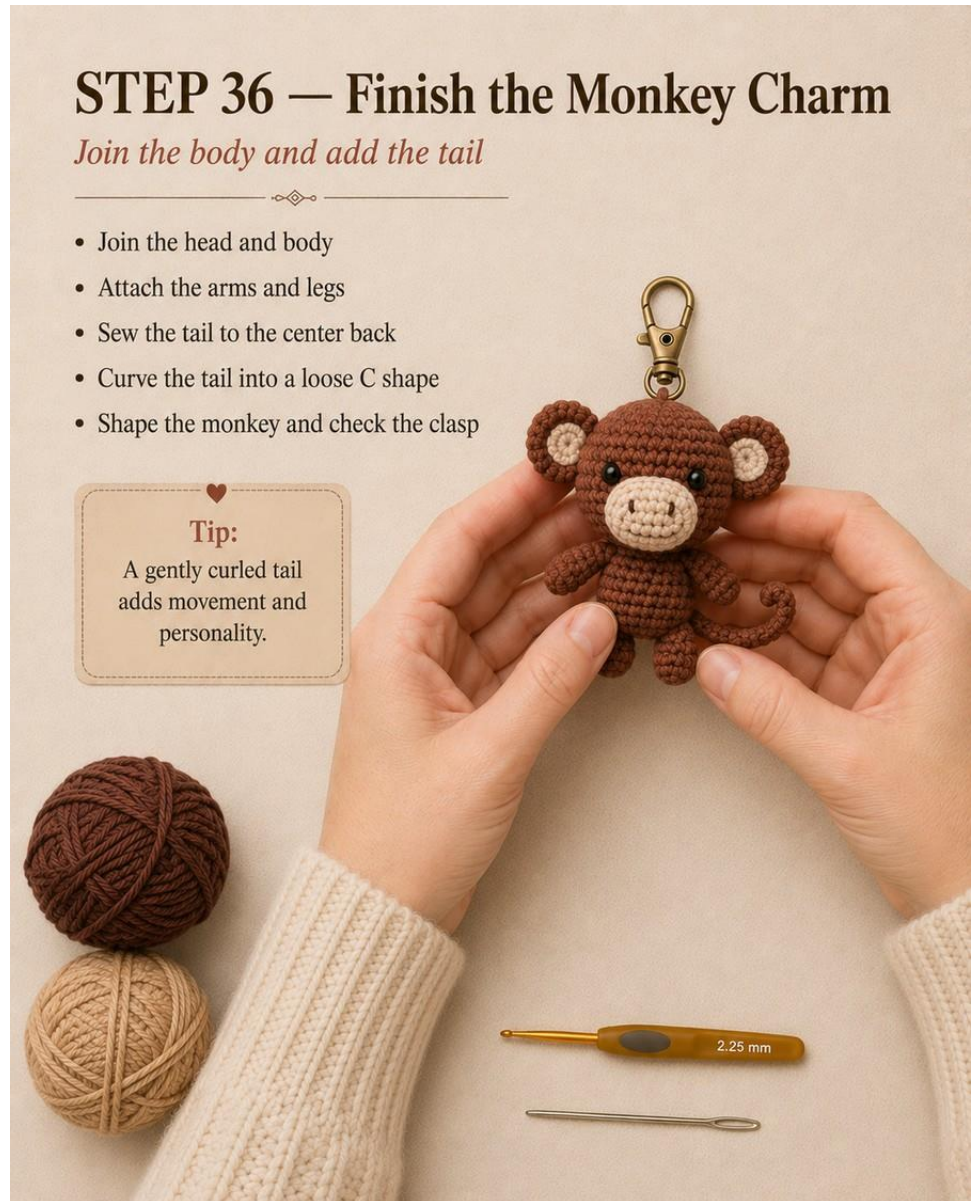
STEP 36 — Finish the Monkey Charm

Join the body and add the tail

- Join the head and body
- Attach the arms and legs
- Sew the tail to the center back
- Curve the tail into a loose C shape
- Shape the monkey and check the clasp

Tip:

A gently curled tail adds movement and personality.



Step 36 - Finish the Monkey Charm

STEP 37 — Start the Rooster Charm

Prepare the comb, wattles, beak and feathers

- Make 3 red comb circles
- Crochet 2 red wattle circles
- Make 1 golden-yellow beak
- Prepare 3 tail feathers in yellow, ivory and warm orange
- Gather the wings, legs, head and body for assembly

Tip:

The comb, wattles and tail feathers define the rooster.



Step 37 - Start the Rooster Charm

STEP 38 — Build the Rooster Face

Attach the beak, wattles and comb

- Sew the beak to the center front
- Attach the 2 wattles beneath the beak
- Sew 3 comb circles across the top of the head
- Keep the features centered and balanced
- Prepare the body pieces for joining

Tip:

Keep the center comb slightly higher than the side combs.



Step 38 - Build the Rooster Face

STEP 39 — Assemble the Rooster Body

Join the body and add the wings and legs

- Join the head and body
- Sew the 2 wings to the sides
- Attach the 2 legs near the lower front
- Embroider small toe lines beneath each leg
- Keep the rooster standing upright and balanced

♥
Tip:

Angle the wings slightly back for a neat bird silhouette.



Step 39 - Assemble the Rooster Body

STEP 40 — Finish the Rooster Charm

Add the tail feathers and final shaping

- Sew the 3 tail feathers to the center back
- Fan the feather tips outward
- Shape the wings and check the symmetry
- Test the clasp and secure loose ends
- Your rooster charm is complete

♥
Tip:

A fanned tail helps the rooster read clearly at a small size.



Step 40 - Finish the Rooster Charm

STEP 41 — Start the Dog Charm

Prepare the floppy ears, muzzle and tail

- Make 2 chocolate-brown floppy ears
- Crochet 1 cream round muzzle
- Make 1 short brown tail
- Gather the caramel head, body, arms and legs for assembly
- Keep all parts small and compact

Tip:

The floppy ears and cream muzzle are the dog's signature details.



Step 41 - Start the Dog Charm

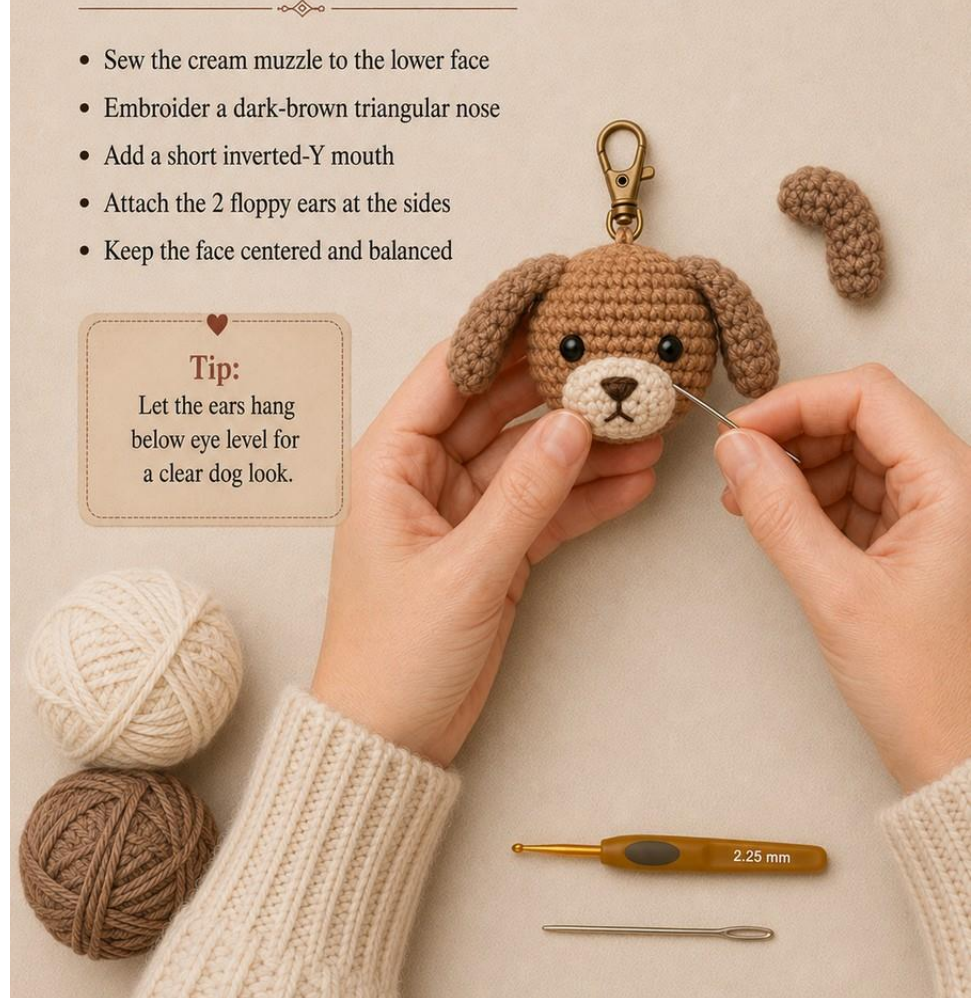
STEP 42 — Build the Dog Face

Attach the muzzle and floppy ears

- Sew the cream muzzle to the lower face
- Embroider a dark-brown triangular nose
- Add a short inverted-Y mouth
- Attach the 2 floppy ears at the sides
- Keep the face centered and balanced

Tip:

Let the ears hang below eye level for a clear dog look.



Step 42 - Build the Dog Face

STEP 43 — Finish the Dog Charm

Join the body and add the tail

- Join the head and body
- Attach the arms and legs
- Sew the tail to the center back
- Curve the tail upward
- Shape the dog and check the clasp

Tip:

Soft floppy ears make the finished dog look friendly and cute.



Step 43 - Finish the Dog Charm

STEP 44 — Start the Pig Charm

Prepare the ears, snout and spiral tail

- Make 2 blush-pink pointed ears
- Crochet 1 darker-pink round snout
- Make 1 curly spiral tail
- Gather the head, body, arms and legs
- Keep the pieces soft and compact

Tip:

The round snout and curly tail make the pig easy to recognize.



Step 44 - Start the Pig Charm

STEP 45 — Build the Pig Face

Attach the snout and pointed ears

- Sew the round snout to the center front
- Embroider 2 nostrils
- Add a small curved mouth
- Attach the 2 pointed ears
- Keep the face centered before joining the body

Tip:

Keep the ears small so the pig still looks compact and chubby.



Step 45 - Build the Pig Face

STEP 46 — Finish the Pig Charm

Join the body and add the curly tail

- Join the head and body
- Attach the arms and legs
- Sew the spiral tail to the center back
- Shape the pig and check the symmetry
- Test the clasp and secure loose ends

Tip:

Leave the tail curl free so the pig keeps its playful shape.



Step 46 - Finish the Pig Charm

Correction: sew the spiral tail to the centre back as stated in the written pattern.

STEP 47 — Complete the Lucky Twelve Collection

Arrange and inspect all 12 finished charms

- Place all 12 zodiac animal charms together
- Check the sizes and color balance
- Confirm that every clasp is secure
- Straighten ears, tails, wings and horns
- Your full collection is complete

Tip:

A cohesive collection looks most premium when the sizes and colors stay consistent.



Step 47 - Complete the Lucky Twelve Collection

REFERENCE COLLECTION

Original visual direction supplied for the pattern bundle



Use the written stitch counts and assembly instructions as the technical authority.

Reference Collection Inspiration

Use the written pattern as the technical authority.

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Happy crocheting!